

About Arista Networks

Arista Networks is an industry leader in data-driven, client-to-cloud networking for large data center, campus and routing environments. Arista is a well-established and profitable company with over \$5 billion in revenue. Arista's award-winning platforms, ranging in Ethernet speeds up to 800G bits per second, redefine scalability, agility, and resilience. Arista is a founding member of the Ultra Ethernet consortium. We have shipped over 20 million cloud networking ports worldwide with CloudVision and EOS, an advanced network operating system. Arista is committed to open standards, and its products are available worldwide directly and through partners.

Online Round:

First, the students who had applied for the company were shortlisted, and only **83 students** were selected to attend the **online test**. Since it was conducted in the department, the students wrote the exam using the **department systems**, not their personal laptops.

The test was conducted on **HackerRank**, and the **password was provided by the company**.

The test consisted of:

- **15 technical MCQs** covering topics like pointers, twisted output-prediction questions, and other programming-related concepts.
- **3 coding questions**, each with a separate time limit.

You could access each section only during its allotted time, but if you completed a question early, you were allowed to **save and proceed** but you have to wait until the time ends.

Next day the interview was in a hybrid mode which comprised of 2 rounds.

Interview Round 1:

Only nine students were shortlisted for the interview, and it was scheduled for the very next day, so I had very little time to prepare. My first round was virtual. It began with a quick self-introduction, after which the interviewer explained the pair-coding process and asked me to share my screen. I was allowed to choose the programming language.

First, he gave me an output-prediction question based on function overriding. I answered it incorrectly, but he guided me to the right answer and then asked multiple output-based questions by making small modifications to the same program.

Next, he asked me to code a function that takes a string as input and returns another string sorted by the frequency of its characters. If two characters had the same frequency, they had to be sorted lexicographically. He handled the input and main function himself, and he asked me to explain my approach and use the assert function to test my implementation.

After that, he asked me to code the flattening of a linked list, which I was already familiar with. Again, he took care of the main function and the printing of the linked list.

He then asked how vectors are implemented internally, and I was only able to answer partially.

Finally, he asked if I had any questions.

Interview Round 2:

Only five students were shortlisted for the second round. Everyone had a different experience in this round — some were asked technical questions again, while others faced project-based discussions. For me, it was mostly HR-style questioning.

Since I was confident about my projects, I tried steering the conversation toward them. However, the interviewer felt that I hadn't done anything new or impactful through my projects. He implied that I hadn't solved any real-world problem and even made me feel as though I had wasted my college life. From his tone, I felt he had already decided not to select me, but I didn't lose hope. I kept trying to convince him that I was a good fit for the company.

Eventually, the interview shifted into technical topics. He asked me what my strength was, and I said Data Structures and Algorithms. He then mentioned the name of an algorithm and asked if I knew it. I hadn't even heard of it before, so I said no. He then asked which algorithms I do know. I asked if he wanted something simple or complex. After his response, I first said Bubble Sort. He told me to choose a more optimal one, so I switched to Merge Sort.

He then asked how I arrived at the time complexity of Merge Sort. I had forgotten the explanation, so I just described how Merge Sort works instead of giving the actual complexity derivation.

In the end, he advised me to participate in more hackathons and work on personal projects.

After two rounds only 2 members were selected for internship.

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All the Best!!